Message from the President, The Robotics Society, India

On behalf of **The Robotics Society (TRS), India**, I warmly welcome all delegates, experts, and participants to the **Two-Day International Workshop on "Intelligent Systems: The Future of Robotics and AI."**

We stand at a critical inflection point where artificial intelligence and advanced robotics are fundamentally redefining human capability both physically and mentally. Robotics has moved beyond industrial automation into autonomous air, ground, surface and underwater vehicles, adaptive medical systems, and intelligent edge machines. By embedding effective localisation, perception and decision-making into physical platforms, intelligent mobile robots are gradually moving towards greater autonomy even in the challenging underwater domain.

This workshop would provide an excellent platform to bridge foundational research with real-world deployment. Over the next two days, I encourage you to challenge existing paradigms, exchange interdisciplinary ideas, and cultivate collaborations that extend well beyond this venue. For our young researchers and students, this is an opportunity to engage directly with the technologies shaping the next frontier of engineering.

I commend the organizing team for curating this timely forum. May these two days spark transformative ideas and push the boundaries of what intelligent systems can achieve.

Warm regards,

Alok Mukherjee

President, The Robotics Society (TRS), India

Short Bio Sketch

Alok Mukherjee is a distinguished defence scientist, technological innovator, and leader in the field of robotics and unmanned systems in India. With over three decades of experience at the Defence Research and Development Organisation (DRDO), he served in pivotal leadership roles, including **Group Director - Robotics** at the Research & Development Establishment (Engineers), Pune.

During his career at DRDO, he played a central role in conceptualizing, designing, and deploying indigenous military-grade robotic systems, tactical platforms, and surveillance technologies for security applications. Notably, he contributed to development of UAV – 'NETRA' —one of India's earliest micro-surveillance drones developed for defence and security operations and ROV – 'Daksh', the first indigenous military robot for Bomb and IED Handling and defusal.

Currently serving as the **President of The Robotics Society (TRS), India**, he actively drives national initiatives to promote robotics research, foster industry-academia collaboration, and mentors emerging engineering talent through student chapters across academic institutions.

Continuing his technological vision beyond defence, he is also an entrepreneur, founding **i4 Marine Technologies P Ltd.**—a Pune-based startup focused on indigenous marine robotics, autonomous surface vessels, underwater ROVs, and environmental monitoring platforms mainly for dams, reservoirs and coastal areas. In this venture he has pioneered water craft development of different types and indigenous electric propulsion system for aquatic mobility applications using green energy reducing pollution of our precious water resources.